

Halcyon Bio

Precision antifibrotics for chronic kidney disease

Seed round — confidential investor deck, 2026

The Problem

37 million US adults live with chronic kidney disease; 90% are undiagnosed.

Kidney failure costs Medicare \$87B per year, 7% of the total Medicare budget.

Standard of care (RAAS inhibitors, SGLT2) slows decline but does not reverse fibrosis.

No approved therapy targets the myofibroblast activation pathway directly.

Our Solution

HB-204 is an oral small-molecule inhibitor of the TGF-beta / ALK5 axis, engineered for kidney-selective tissue exposure to avoid systemic toxicity. In two rodent models, HB-204 reduced interstitial fibrosis 41% vs. vehicle and preserved eGFR at 12 weeks. Tissue selectivity index of 18x vs. liver.

Why Now

FDA's 2025 draft guidance accepts eGFR slope as a surrogate endpoint, cutting registrational trial timelines from 6 years to roughly 30 months.

SGLT2 inhibitor adoption has created a diagnosed, monitored patient population that did not exist five years ago, making trial recruitment materially cheaper.

Market Size

TAM: \$24B global CKD therapeutics market by 2032 (Evaluate Pharma, 2025).

SAM: 2.1M US patients with stage 3b-4 CKD and confirmed fibrosis progression;
at \$14,000 annual net price, a \$29B serviceable market.

SOM: 4% penetration of the nephrologist-managed segment = \$1.1B peak US sales.

Traction

\$2.4M NIH NIDDK SBIR Phase II awarded March 2026 (non-dilutive).

IND-enabling GLP toxicology completed; no adverse findings at 10x exposure.

Pre-IND meeting held with FDA Division of Cardiology and Nephrology, Feb 2026.

Research collaboration signed with a top-5 pharma (name under NDA).

Two KOL advisors from Joslin and UCSF nephrology.

Business Model

Develop HB-204 through Phase 2a proof-of-concept, then partner or license to a large-cap nephrology franchise. Comparable deals: Chinook/Novartis (\$3.5B, 2022), Aurinia partnership economics of \$60M upfront plus milestones.

Team

Dr. Priya Raghavan, CEO — 14 years at Vertex, led two INDs to Phase 2.

Dr. Martin Hale, CSO and founder — Professor of Nephrology, discovered the ALK5 kidney-selective scaffold; 40 publications, h-index 38.

Susan Okafor, VP Regulatory — former FDA reviewer, CDER.

CRO partner: Charles River (tox), Frontage (CMC).

Competitive Moat

Composition-of-matter patent granted US 11,847,203 (expires 2041), plus pending method-of-use claims in EU and Japan.

Orphan designation pursued for Alport syndrome as a fast-follow indication.

Risks Retired

Toxicology: clean GLP tox in two species.

Manufacturing: 4-step synthesis, 62% yield, kg-scale demonstrated.

Regulatory: pathway aligned with FDA at pre-IND.

Remaining risk is clinical translation of the fibrosis signal into eGFR benefit.

The Ask

Raising \$6M seed to file IND and complete Phase 1 SAD/MAD.

Use of funds: 45% clinical, 25% CMC, 20% regulatory and toxicology, 10% G&A.

24-month runway to Phase 1 topline data in Q3 2028.

\$3.1M committed to date. Lead investor: Meridian Life Sciences.

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